



VisitCentral



Destination

Sigiriya

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Sigiriya or Sinhagiri is an ancient rock fortress located in Matale district. It is a site of historical and archaeological significance that is dominated by a massive **column** of rock approximately 180 metres (590 ft) high. Sigiriya, a world heritage site nominated by UNESCO in 1982. King **Kashyapa** (477 – 495 AD) built his palace on top of this rock and decorated its sides with colourful **frescoes**. On a small plateau about halfway up the side of this rock he built a gateway in the form of an enormous lion. The Lion Rock fortress of



It is likely that the area around Sigiriya may have been inhabited since prehistoric times. The earliest evidence of human habitation at Sigiriya is the Aligala rock shelter to the east of Sigiriya rock, indicating that the area was occupied nearly five thousand years ago during the **Mesolithic Period**.

Sigiriya is considered to be one of the most important urban planning sites of the first millennium, and the **site plan** is considered very elaborate and imaginative. The plan combined concepts of symmetry and asymmetry to intentionally interlock the man-made geometrical and natural forms of the surroundings. On the west side of the rock lies a park for the royals, laid out on a symmetrical plan; the park contains water-retaining structures, including sophisticated surface/subsurface hydraulic systems, some of which are working today. The south contains a man-made reservoir; these were extensively used from the previous capital of the dry zone of Sri Lanka. Five gates were placed at entrances. The more elaborate western gate is thought to have been reserved for the royals.

The paintings would have covered most of the western face of the rock, an area 140 metres long and 40 metres high. There are references in the graffiti to 500 ladies in these paintings. However, most have been lost forever. More frescoes, different from those on the rock face, can be seen elsewhere, for example on the ceiling of the location called the "Cobra Hood Cave". The true identity of the ladies in these paintings still has not been confirmed. There are various ideas about their identity. Some believe that they are the ladies of the kings while others think that they are women taking part in religious observances. These pictures have a close resemblance to paintings seen in the **Ajanta Caves in India**.

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...the passage, the wall is now partially covered with verses scribbled by visitors, some of them dating from as early as the 8th century. People of all walks of life, from poets to provincial governors to housewives, wrote on the wall. they wrote poetry on varying subjects such as love, irony, and experiences of all sorts. This is the only evidence of poetry found in the **Anuradhapura** period.

Toile Facilities: Yes**Disable accessibilities: No****Distance from Dambulla: 17km****Tickets: Yes**

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Pidurangala Rock

Pidurangala Rock is an incredible 360-degree viewpoint located opposite the world-famous Sigiriya Lion Rock. Hiking to the top is possible for both of these roc...



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Popham's Arboretum is situated in Dambulla. It is Sri Lanka's only dry zone Arboretum that contains a large variety of trees, birds, butterflies, dragonflies, a...



Loolecondera Tea Estate

This is the birthplace of world-renowned Ceylon Tea. From Peradeniya Galha Junction, travel via Peradeniya University and continue for 22km on Galaha Road to re...



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This lesser-known Deanston is situated right in the center of the tropical island of Sri Lanka, not far from Kandy. Nonetheless, Deanston in Knuckles Range is s...



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Meemure is a traditional village surrounded by the Knuckles Range of mountains situated on the border between Kandy and Matale Districts in the Central Province...



Muesum of Wall Painting in Dambulla

The Museum of wall Painting of the Central Cultural Fund is located in the Rangiri Dambulla Raja Maha Vihara premises in Dambulla. This purpose of this mus...



Captain Dawson Tower & Kadugannawa Rock Tunnel

The Colombo-Kandy road (A1) was built by Captain W. F. Dawson of the Royal Engineers, during the tenure of Governor Edward Barnes. Dawson died in Colombo on 28t...



Alagalla Mountain Range

A distinctive geographic location, this mountain range is found within the Alagalla Ihala Grama Niladhari Division, towards the southwest of the Thumpane Divisi...



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**An initiative supported through the 'Transforming Tourism in Sri Lanka' project to build back tourism
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